MIL-S-15754D

6 February 1968

SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-15754C
7 April 1965

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SEALS, HAND IMPRESSION

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers hand impression seals.

1.2 Classification.- Hand impression seals shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Wax
Type II - Press, desk type

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

*	QQ-B-626	-	Brass, Leaded and Nonleaded; Rod, Shaped, Forgings, and Flat Products with Finished Edges (Bar and Strip).
*	QQ-S-698	-	Steel, Sheet and Strip, Low-Carbon.
	UU-P-121	-	Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
	JJJ-S-151	-	Sealing Wax.
	PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
	PPP-B-636	-	Box, Fiberboard.
	PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.

FSC 7520

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Preproduction sample.- When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished seal covered by this specification shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production seal.

* 3.2 Standard product.- The hand impression seals covered by this specification shall be the regular commercial product of the manufacturer except for changes necessary to comply with the specification requirements.

* 3.3 Materials.- Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used for the purpose in standard industry practice.

* 3.3.1 Brass.- The brass shall conform to copper alloy numbers 342, 353, or 360, half hard of QQ-B-626.

* 3.3.2 Low carbon steel sheet and strip.- The steel shall conform to hot or cold rolled, any quality or temper of QQ-S-698.

* 3.4 Construction.-

* 3.4.1 Type I, wax seal.- The type I wax seal shall consist of a circular die 1-1/4 inches in diameter, plus or minus 1/32 inch, with an integral wood screw shank and a wooden handle. The die shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall be a minimum of 0.250 inch thick. The handle shall be fabricated from hardwood with a nickel-plated metal ferrule on the circular die end. The ferrule shall have a hole through which the wood screw shank is inserted into the handle. The other end of the handle shall be formed in a ball or oval shape for convenient handling.

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The over-all height of the seal, including handle and circular die shall be not more than 3-3/4 inches. The wax seal shall produce clear and sharp impressions when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

* 3.4.2 Type II, press seal.- The press seal shall consist of a body, a moveable upper and a fixed lower plate, and a lever. The upper plate shall be detachable. The body and the lever shall be fabricated from cast iron or commercial grade high tensile wrought steel, or at the option of the supplier, the body may be fabricated from two steel plates, not less than 0.125 inch thick spaced and riveted together. The moveable upper plate shall be fabricated from not less than 0.250 inch thick brass specified in 3.3.1, and the fixed lower plate shall be fabricated from a nonferrous alloy. One end of the lever shall be secured to the body of the press seal by a steel pintle pin and the other end shall be formed to fit the palm of the hand. The press seal shall be a minimum of 4-1/2 inches in length and of a size to produce an embossed permanent impression a minimum of 1-9/16 inches in diameter when tested as specified in 4.4.3. The press seal shall withstand a load of 50 pounds without deforming the lever or body, or distorting the die when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

* 3.4.3 Inscription.- The inscription on the hand seals shall be as specified (see 6.2).

* 3.4.4 Performance.- No impressions other than that specified in 6.2, no errors in the inscription, and no filling in of closed portions of letters or other characters shall be present when the wax and press seals are tested as specified in 4.4. The depth of the impression shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

* 3.5 Finish.-

* 3.5.1 Type I, wax seal.- The handle of the type I wax seal shall be given a coat of either varnish or enamel, or a natural color stain and polished in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

* 3.5.2 Type II, press seal.- The surface of all the metal parts except the upper and the lower plate shall be either painted or plated in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

* 3.6 Workmanship.- The surface of the hand impression seals shall be free of burrs, slivers, rough or sharp edges. Components shall not be broken, cracked or malformed. The varnish, or enamel, or natural color stain paint or plate coating shall level out to a continuous smooth, dry film thickness without runs, drops, streaks or area of no film. The coating shall be free from embedded foreign matter and shall show no evidence of peeling, flaking or blistering.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 Preproduction sample inspection.- When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for the defects listed in table I, dimensions specified, and tested as specified in 4.4.

* 4.3 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

* 4.3.1 Components and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and material shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

* 4.3.2 End-item inspection.- The lot shall be all of the hand impression seals of one type offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated hand impression seal.

* 4.3.2.1 Visual examination.- Examination shall be made of the end item for defects in table I. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I.- Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Finish	Not type specified		X
	Handle not polished (when applicable for type I)		X
	Not continuous or smooth		X

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TABLE I.- Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Finish (cont'd)	Contains runs, drops, or streaks		X
	Area of no film		X
	Foreign matter imbedded		X
	Evidence of peeling, flaking or blistering		X
	Not painted or plated, as applicable (type II)		X
	Ferrule not nickel-plated		X
Construction and workmanship	Burrs, slivers, rough or sharp edges	X	
	Handle not fabricated from hardwood	X	
	Metal ferrule missing on die end of handle	X	
	Die not secured to handle	X	
	Handle not ball-or-oval-shaped		X
	Steel plates not riveted, when applicable	X	
	Lever not secured with a steel pintle pin	X	
	Lever not formed to fit palm of hand		X

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TABLE I.- Classification of Defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Inscription	Omitted, incomplete, misspelled, illegible, incorrect, wrong size	X	

* 4.3.2.2 Dimensional examination.- Examination shall be made of the hand impression seals for compliance with dimensions specified. Any deviation therefrom shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

* 4.3.2.3 Testing of end item.- Hand seals shall be tested as specified in 4.4. Any nonconformance shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

* 4.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be in accordance with table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. The lot shall be the number of shipping containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S2 with an AQL of 2.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II.- Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as bulging or distortion of containers.
Contents	Number per package is more or less than required.

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* 4.3.4 Examination of shipping containers.- When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing, and reinforcing shall be made in accordance with the appendix of the specification.

4.4 Tests.-

* 4.4.1 Load test, type II.- The hand impression seal shall be placed upright in the normal operating position on a platform scale. The scale shall be equipped with a suitable apparatus to apply a force evenly to the lever in the same fashion one would normally operate the press seal. After applying and releasing a test load of 50 pounds, the seal shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.4.2. Any noncompliance shall be considered a defect.

* 4.4.2 Impression test type I, wax seal.- Sealing wax conforming to type I, grade A of JJJ-S-151, and bond paper conforming to type IV of UU-P-121 shall be used for this test. Test shall be made under ambient temperature of 73°F. ± 3.5°F. and a relative humidity of 50 percent ± 2 percent. A minimum of three seals shall be made on the bond paper from hot melted wax. The die, at room temperature, shall be pressed into the hot wax and be immediately removed. The impression shall be examined for conformance with 3.4.1.

* 4.4.3 Type II, press seal.- A sheet of 16 pound (17 x 22 - 500) substance weight bond paper shall be placed between the upper and lower plates. A force of not more than 50 pounds shall then be applied to the lever in the manner described in 4.4.1. The embossed impression shall be examined for compliance with 3.4.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.- Each seal shall be individually packaged in a folding or setup paperboard box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

* 5.1.2 Level C.- Seals shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

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* 5.2.1 Level A.- Seals, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing by means of tape, and reinforcing with flat strapping or tape banding, shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents shall not exceed 65 pounds.

* 5.2.2 Level B.- Unless otherwise specified (see 5.2.2.1) seals, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW or type SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents shall not exceed 65 pounds.

* 5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a V3c or V3s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

* 5.2.3 Level C.- Seals, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

* 5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- Hand impression seals covered by this specification are intended for use as follows:

* 6.1.1 Type I.- For producing a seal impression on sealing wax.

* 6.1.2 Type II.- For producing an embossed seal on paper.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type of seal required (see 1.2).
* (c) When preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
* (d) Inscription required (see 3.4.3).
* (e) Level of packaging required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
* (f) When V3c or V3s fiberboard is required for level B pack (see 5.2.2.1).

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* 6 3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

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Review activities:

Air Force - 84, 85

User activities:

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Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
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INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

MIL-S-15754D, Seals, Hand Impression

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE
U. S. Army Natick Labs.	Natick, Mass. 01760

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

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